COST Intelligence Report

Report as_of: **2026-10-31** | Market data as_of: **2026-10-30** | Market fetched: **2026-11-01 01:51 UTC**

Costco Wholesale Corporation | Consumer Defensive / Discount Stores

AI status: **Available** | Configured model: **openai/gpt-oss-20b** | News snapshot: **2026-10-31**

Previously reviewed headlines reused from integrity-verified archive: **11**; archived source date **2026-10-30**. Reused classifications are not fresh model calls.

Report rendering uses saved source snapshots with separate observation dates. The daily price bar may be provisional before the listing market closes. Check source dates and availability.

Publication-age audit (relative to report date): 16 in the current event window; 1 presented as historical context; 0 missing publication dates. Recent publication does not verify the underlying claim.

News (report-date window: previous 7 days plus report date): **24** unique headlines; **24** classified or explicitly excluded; **0** still unclassified. Named publishers: **9**. Latest RSS publication: **2026-10-31**.

Quantitative

Metric	Value
Close	1012.2800
Return 1D (%)	1.7766
Return 1W (%)	1.0422
Return 1M (%)	11.3624
Return YTD (%)	18.0799
Return 1Y (%)	10.8143
Annualized volatility (%)	19.8874
Beta vs SPY	-0.1976
Max drawdown (%)	-18.1993
Sharpe (rf=0)	0.6176
Downside deviation (rf=0, %)	13.7040
Sortino (rf=0)	0.8963
Historical VaR 95% (1D, %)	2.0766
Historical ES 95% (1D, %)	2.7374
Correlation vs SPY	-0.1271
Tracking error vs SPY (%)	24.9741
P/E (trailing)	48.76
P/B	12.53
EV/EBITDA	30.84
Revenue growth (%)	11.10
Forward P/E (estimate)	40.45
Gross margin (%)	12.77
Operating margin (%)	3.79

Metric	Value
Return on equity (%)	28.40
Free cash flow yield (%)	1.51
MA50	941.9411
Close vs MA50 (%)	7.4674
MA200	967.8804
Close vs MA200 (%)	4.5873
RSI (14, Wilder)	66.8749
MACD (12,26)	19.2825
MACD signal (9)	18.5329
MACD histogram	0.7496

Methodology: adjusted daily closes (yfinance auto_adjust=True; Stooq fallback if unavailable). 1Y return uses the last trading day on or before the one-year boundary. Risk metrics use historical returns and are not forecasts; asset and SPY returns are not FX-adjusted in cross-listing comparisons. Free cash flow yield is unavailable unless vendor financial and listing currencies match. See unavailable values as N/A.

HOW TO READ THE QUANTITATIVE SECTION

These rule-based bands are judgment choices for this research report, not investment advice.

The table above contains the complete metric set. This compact guide highlights ten research-context measures; definitions and full interpretation are retained in the accompanying Markdown and data snapshots.

- **Return 1D (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over one trading day is measured as a percentage. Observed: 1.7766. Adjusted price rose over this period.
- **Return 1Y (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over one year is measured as a percentage. Observed: 10.8143. Adjusted price rose over this period.
- **Annualized volatility (%)**: The variability of daily returns is scaled to one year as a percentage. Observed: 19.8874. Low annualized volatility.
- **Historical VaR 95% (1D, %)**: Observed daily loss at the empirical fifth-percentile return, floored at zero; not a maximum loss. Observed: 2.0766.
- **Historical ES 95% (1D, %)**: Average observed loss in returns at or below the empirical fifth percentile, floored at zero. Observed: 2.7374.
- **Beta vs SPY**: Beta estimates how sensitively returns move with the SPY market benchmark. Observed: -0.1976. Inverse market sensitivity.
- **Max drawdown (%)**: The largest peak-to-trough price decline in the sampled history is measured as a percentage. Observed: -18.1993. Moderate peak-to-trough loss magnitude.
- **Sharpe (rf=0)**: Sharpe measures annualized return per unit of volatility using a zero risk-free rate. Observed: 0.6176. Modest risk-adjusted return.
- **P/E (trailing)**: The share price is divided by trailing earnings per share. Observed: 48.7611. High trailing earnings multiple under the research bands.
- **RSI (14, Wilder)**: The 14-period relative strength index compares recent gains with losses on a 0 to 100 scale. Observed: 66.8749. Neutral momentum reading.

Tailwinds

1. Costco Stock’s Long-Term Upside Could Come From These 3 Competitive Advantages

Highlights three competitive advantages that could drive long-term upside for Costco.

Date: **2026-10-29** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **long** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 2 days before report date.

Sources: 24/7 Wall St.

2. What Did It Take To Hold Costco Stock?

Discusses criteria and benefits of holding Costco shares.

Date: **2026-10-29** | Impact: **low** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 2 days before report date.

Sources: Trefis

3. $100 Invested In Costco Wholesale 5 Years Ago Would Be Worth This Much Today

Shows historical growth, indicating strong past performance for Costco.

Date: **2026-10-30** | Impact: **high** | Horizon: **long** | Confidence: **0.95**

Publication age: 1 days before report date.

Sources: Benzinga

4. Costco Wholesale (NASDAQ:COST) Stock Jumps 1.6% - Time to Buy?

Reports a 1.6% stock jump, suggesting short-term positive momentum.

Date: **2026-10-30** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 1 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

5. 14,584 Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Shares Acquired by International Assets Investment Management LLC

International Assets Investment Management purchased 14,584 Costco shares, indicating institutional ownership activity.

Date: **2026-10-31** | Impact: **low** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.88**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

Headwinds

1. Costco Stock's Valuation Remains A Head Scratcher (NASDAQ:COST)

Valuation concerns for Costco stock.

Date: **2026-10-28** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 3 days before report date (historical context; not a new market-moving event).

Sources: Seeking Alpha

Catalysts

1. Costco Stock (COST) Ticks Up as the FTC Launches Pricing Probe into Rivals Walmart and Target

Date: **2026-10-29** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 2 days before report date.

Sources: TipRanks

2. Costco (COST) Weighs Special Dividend Amid Strategic Investment Plans for 2027

Date: **2026-10-31** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: GuruFocus

3. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Stock Sold by Payden & Rygel

Date: **2026-10-31** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

4. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Shares Sold by Avestar Capital LLC

Date: **2026-10-31** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

5. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Stock Sold by Convergence Financial LLC

Date: **2026-10-29** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 2 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

6. Costco (COST) Ascends While Market Falls: Some Facts to Note

Costco shares rise as broader market declines, indicating relative strength.

Date: **2026-10-29** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 2 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance

7. Costco: Special Dividend Prospects Meet Expensive Valuations And Mixed Macros

Costco may issue a special dividend amid high valuations and mixed macro conditions.

Date: **2026-10-27** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 4 days before report date.

Sources: Seeking Alpha

8. Talking Costco: Why a special dividend might not be the right play (COST:NASDAQ)

Analysis questions the value of a potential special dividend for Costco shareholders.

Date: **2026-10-31** | Impact: **low** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: Seeking Alpha

9. Partners Wealth Management LLC Purchases New Position in Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST

A wealth management firm increased its Costco holdings, indicating investor confidence.

Date: **2026-10-31** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

10. Own Costco Stock by Oct. 30 to Qualify for Its Nov. 13 Dividend. Here's How Many Shares You'd Need for $1,000 in Yearly Dividends.

Investors can earn $1,000 annually by holding enough Costco shares before Oct. 30 to qualify for the Nov. 13 dividend.

Date: **2026-10-27** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 4 days before report date.

Sources: The Motley Fool

Risks

1. Should Medicare Push Require Action From Costco (COST) Investors?

Raises potential regulatory pressure from Medicare, posing a risk to investors.

Date: **2026-10-30** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 1 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance

Peer Comparables

Ticker	P/E	P/B	EV/EBITDA	Rev growth (%)	Mkt cap (local)	1Y ret (%)
COST	**48.76**	**12.53**	**30.84**	**11.10**	**448.57B USD**	**10.81**
WMT	44.75	9.99	23.82	5.90	982.90B USD	21.83
TGT	16.03	3.93	9.77	5.30	70.13B USD	72.87
BJ	23.48	6.18	14.04	15.70	13.56B USD	19.86

Peers fetched as_of: 2026-10-31; COST reuses existing data. Fundamentals are yfinance info snapshots; missing values are not interpolated.

Earnings Calendar

Last reported earnings: **2026-09-24**
Next expected earnings: **2026-12-10** (yfinance; expected dates may change)

Macro (FRED)

Metric	Series	Latest value	Obs. date
Unemployment rate (%)	UNRATE	4.200	2026-09-01
Consumer Price Index (1982–1984=100)	CPIAUCSL	336.298	2026-09-01
Federal funds rate (%)	FEDFUNDS	3.750	2026-09-01
ISM Manufacturing PMI	NAPM	N/A	N/A

Fetched as_of: 2026-10-31

Latest Filing (EDGAR)

Form: **10-K** | Filing date: **2026-10-07**
Revenue (latest quarter): 69,597,000,000.00 USD; period 2025-11-24/2026-02-15; fiscal 2026/Q2
Net income (latest quarter): 2,192,000,000.00 USD; period 2026-02-16/2026-05-10; fiscal 2026/Q3
SEC filing: Open on SEC EDGAR

SEC requests use the configured organization and contact identity. Financial values use directly reported periods of approximately three months, without deriving quarters from cumulative values.

Sources

- [1] 24/7 Wall St. (news.google.com)
- [2] Trefis (news.google.com)
- [3] Benzinga (news.google.com)
- [4] MarketBeat (news.google.com)
- [5] MarketBeat (news.google.com)
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- [16] The Motley Fool (news.google.com)
- [17] Yahoo Finance (news.google.com)

API documentation: SEC EDGAR APIs | FRED observations

Research notes and limitations

Daily multi-source research; AI items require human spot checks; RSS coverage is not guaranteed. Missing market data or fundamentals are marked N/A; no numbers are fabricated.

This report is not investment advice.